

your followers are saying with respect to your brand. A more advanced way of doing it would be to use a tool like Social mention, which uses its algorithms to find out what other users are saying about you, your brand, your industry, and all other relevant details.

Just because your Twitter account is automated, doesn't mean you don't have any responsibility in the monitoring and engagement department. Personally written tweets will go a long way in convincing your followers that your account doesn't just spam your content onto their feeds. Another red flag is to give in to the basest of automated account tricks – to follow an unfollow legions of people. Not only does this stop you from building a loyal base set of followers, it is against Twitter laws, and could get you booted from Twitter's search results.

Twitter wouldn't be nearly as popular as it is if it hadn't been for its superior use of analytics to track and demarcate trends better than any other social networking site in the business. So, any analysis of how Twitter works will be half done if it doesn't give some space to this essential part of trend making. I am, of course, talking about the vaunted hashtag.

How to get your hashtag trending

What exactly is a hashtag? Twitter is the birthplace of this modern day phenomena, with other social media platforms quickly adopting it after they saw its popularity. Giants such as Instagram, Facebook, Tumblr, Pinterest and the like all use it now. While it's specific usage differs, in general, it is used to denote a certain specific topics of conversation. Twitter also curates a 'Trends' tab on the side of your Twitter feed that is a list of the most popular hashtags in a category of your choosing. These trends can be modified to reflect your interests, or your political opinions, or the place you live in. When you click on a hashtag, there are three categories that the Twitter search has – "Top", "All", and "People You Follow".

Now that everyone is aware of what a hashtag is, let us get down to the crux of the matter – how do you trend your own hashtag. This, as with everything else related to this website comes with it's own caveats. You can't, for example, have 15 followers and expect to trend a hashtag. On the other hand, you can't expect everything you say to turn into a hashtag just because you have a large follower count. Here are a few specific tips and tricks you might use when you try to trend your very own hashtag –

- ◆ To start off, it is mandatory to understand that creating a trending hashtag is incredibly hard, just because of the number of variables